2.4 Chronic Pain*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My back has hurt for more than a year." • Pain around 6/10 on most days **Objective** • Altered posture and gait • Activity much reduced • Long-term analgesic use	**ACTUAL** Chronic pain related to a chronic musculoskeletal condition as evidenced by pain persisting > 3 months and reduced activity.	• Within a week, pain at a level that allows daily activities. • Uses two non-drug methods of pain relief.	• Explore the pattern of pain, its triggers and its effect on her day. • Give analgesics regularly, as prescribed. • Teach heat application, relaxation and pacing of activities. • Encourage graded exercise in line with physiotherapy advice. • Discuss the hazards of analgesic overuse.	• Considered met when daily activities are managed with pain of 4/10 or less. • If not, refer to the pain clinic.
Subjective • "I cannot fall asleep because of the pain." **Objective** • Tired; difficulty concentrating • Under 4 hours of sleep a night	**ACTUAL** Ineffective sleep pattern related to persistent pain as evidenced by difficulty initiating sleep and fatigue.	• Reports better sleep within 1 week.	• Take a sleep history. • Recommend a fixed bedtime and no caffeine in the evening. • Give bedtime analgesia as prescribed. • Teach a short relaxation routine for use before sleep.	• Goal reached if she sleeps 6 hours or more.
Subjective • "Nothing I do helps." **Objective** • Long-standing illness • No longer able to fulfil her work and family roles	**RISK** Risk for impaired resilience as evidenced by risk factors: chronic illness and perceived loss of control over daily life.	• Takes part in decisions about her pain plan.	• Set goals with her rather than for her. • Offer choices about when care and activity take place. • Point out small gains as they occur. • Refer to a support group or counseling where appropriate.	• Met when she contributes to planning and sets realistic goals.

* **References for this care plan:** [35], [48], [76], [110], [130]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.